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SEPTEMBER 22, 2026

The week guardrails became the product.

Florida turned school AI rules into parent notices, opt-ins, tool lists, and companion bans, while India and South Korea showed what supervised AI practice can look like in classrooms.

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Top story

FLORIDA · K-12 AND COLLEGES

A state rulebook turns AI from a classroom choice into governed infrastructure.

WUSF reports that Florida approved statewide AI rules requiring districts and charter schools to write AI policies into internet-safety rules, notify parents when classroom tools are approved, and maintain public tool lists.

The significant move is what Florida excludes: schools may not adopt AI tools designed to simulate friendship, companionship, or emotional relationships with students. The rule also requires opt-in/out processes, non-AI alternatives, data protections, teacher training, and ways for students to demonstrate mastery without AI.

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The most important AI feature this week was not personalization. It was permission.

Evidence is pointing toward supervised, source-aware use.

Long-run STEM research got another five years.

UNC-Chapel Hill says the NSF renewed EngageAI through 2031 with another \$20 million, backing adaptive K-12 STEM lessons, long-term learner memory, teacher authoring tools, and classroom studies.

Source-backed AI is becoming assessable.

Donga Science described Jinsan Middle School's AI inquiry competition, where teachers could review students' questions, sources, conversation history, and evolving hypotheses rather than only the final report.

Homework evidence keeps weakening.

Croatia Week reports that Croatian schools and universities are questioning whether essays, homework, and seminars still prove independent learning when AI can draft them in minutes.

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Nordic focus

The Nordics keep treating AI as an age, privacy, and proof question.

🇳🇴 NORWAY Norway remains a reference point for age-gating: Euronews noted that its primary-school generative-AI ban preceded New York's move and highlighted gaps in wider EU rules.

🇳🇴 OSLO Oslo's ban on camera-equipped smart glasses in schools continues the Nordic privacy line around ambient data collection and student consent. The Local Norway

🇩🇰 DENMARK Denmark's oral-defense requirement remains the clearest proof-of-learning model: written take-home work must be defended orally, with tighter monitoring during in-school exams. Euronews

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Around the globe

What else moved this week.

🇮🇳 INDIA Sikkim rolled out AI-FunZone in 71 government schools, using adaptive reading and math practice for Classes 3-5 while keeping teachers central. Jagran Josh

🇻🇳 VIETNAM Hanoi will introduce AI content for every Grade 1-12 student, with 12 core lessons, no separate grades, and criteria for approved tools.

 **CROATIA** Teachers say AI-written homework is pushing schools and universities to rethink assessment away from unsupervised take-home tasks. [Croatia Week](#)

 **SOUTH KOREA** Jinsan Middle School's inquiry competition showed source-verified AI being used to track student questioning and scientific reasoning, not just answers. [Donga Science](#)

 **UAE** The UAE's systemwide K-12 AI curriculum remains a leading national example of moving AI from elective activity into formal school structure. [Gulf Business](#)

 **NEPAL** Nepal's Grade 1-12 curriculum overhaul continues to pair AI readiness with indigenous knowledge and practical classroom reform. [Kathmandu Post on MSN](#)

The product story is shifting from tools to controls.

AI-FunZone shows adaptive practice as school infrastructure.

Sikkim's system listens to reading, detects math errors, adapts practice, and gives teachers dashboards, but the state also acknowledges infrastructure gaps around devices, headsets, and connectivity.

[ET Education](#)

Science Donga Air Edu centers verified sources.

The Korean platform is built on a corpus of science articles and exposes source trails, giving teachers a clearer view of whether AI is supporting inquiry or replacing it.

Donga Science

Workplace learning wants sensemaking, not tool churn.

Training Journal framed professional AI learning as a need for L&D and HR to slow down, question vendor claims, and shape adoption decisions rather than inherit them.

Three patterns to track.

Permission systems are becoming part of pedagogy.

Parent choice, age review, approved-tool lists, and non-AI alternatives are moving from legal compliance into everyday classroom design.

Process records are becoming the new anti-cheating layer.

Oral defense, source trails, prompt logs, and teacher dashboards all answer the same question: how did the student think?

Companion AI may be the next hard boundary.

Florida's ban on relationship-building student tools could travel quickly because it gives policymakers a concrete safety line while still allowing instructional AI.

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